Global Context:
Specified Concept:

Archaeologists at Work: Civilization Stations

Observation Task Sheet · Day 1 · Introduction to Civilizations

Name:	Date:	Group:

Your Mission

Today you are an **archaeologist**! You will visit **3 stations** and spend about **10 minutes** at each one. At every station, look closely at the images, read any information cards, and write down what you notice. Your notes will help us in our class discussion tomorrow.

Think Like an Archaeologist: Observe, Then Infer

Archaeologists first **observe** (write what they can actually see) and then **infer** (make a smart guess about what it means).

Observe: what I can SEE	Infer: what I THINK it means
"The object is round and has a hole in the middle."	"I think it was used to ... because ..."

Archaeologist's checklist. Look for:

- **Shape and size:** Is it round, square, tall, flat? Big or small?
- **Material:** What do you think it is made of (clay, stone, metal, wood)?
- **Marks and patterns:** Are there lines, pictures, symbols, or carvings?
- **Condition:** Is it whole or broken? Does it look worn from use?
- **Information card:** Where was it discovered?

Station 1: Building and Early Farming

Image	What I see (shape, material, size, parts, details)	Where was it found? (info card)	Why do I think it was made or built?
1			
2			
3			

Quick sketch: Draw one thing that caught your eye. Label its parts.

Think about it	My thoughts
What problem or need might the people have been trying to solve?	
What would people have needed (workers, tools, time, planning) to make these?	
What questions do I still have?	

Station 2: Ways of Writing

Image	What I see (shapes, lines, symbols; pictures or wedges? how are they arranged?)	Where was it found? (info card)	Can I tell what it says? Why or why not?
1			
2			
3			

Think about it	My thoughts
How are these three kinds of writing ALIKE?	
How are they DIFFERENT?	
Why might people have wanted to write things down? How could writing help a society?	
What questions do I still have?	

Station 3: Everyday Objects and Tools

Image	What I see (shape, size, material, patterns or decoration, signs of wear)	Where was it found? (info card)	How might people have used it?
1			
2			
3			

Quick sketch: Draw one object. Label its parts.

Think about it	My thoughts
Why would these objects be useful to the people who made them?	
Would we still find something like this useful today? Explain.	
What questions do I still have?	

After the Stations: Get Ready to Talk!

Tomorrow we will discuss what we found. Use your notes to get ready.

Question	My thoughts
Which station surprised me the most,and why?	
Which image or object do I most want to learn more about?	
Do I think every invention is made to meet people's needs? Give one example from today's stations.	

Handy sentence starters:

- "I noticed that ..."
- "I think this was used for ... because ..."
- "This reminds me of ... that we use today."
- "I wonder why ..."